Preliminary Written Exam

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
	Type i.e. paper, take home, timed (how long), closed-book, open-book response to questions	**Exam taken** When do students take the written preliminary exam? At what point in the program (months)?	**Exam Due** How long do students have to complete the written exam?	**Notifcation** Who will notify the student about exam results (e.g. faculty who ask exam question? adviser?)? Is revision allowed and/or required? If so, how long does the student have to revise the exam?	**Evaluation Completed** Length of time after final submission of exams by which student will be notified of results.
Art Ed-(2005 Info)	Contact adviser.		committee members submit a question; students have two weeks (or more if needed) to respond and submit	Each committee member who submitted the question assesses the student's response prior to scheduling the oral exam.	
CaT	Two papers on topics related to student's scholarly interests (sometimes 1 larger paper is written) 20-30 pages; adviser sets one question and another committee member sets the second;		Each paper should be completed 4-6 weeks after the exam question was set; Two papers may be completed on different time schedules, but should be completed in close proximity.	The faculty member advising the paper will return it to the student with an evaluation approximately 3 weeks after it was submitted. If either paper results in a	Approximately 3 weeks.

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
	2-page abstract to be sent to person 2-3 weeks after question set			Deferred Pass, the student will be notified of what is required in order to have the conditions removed. If either paper results in a Fail, matriculation is suspended and the student must request permission to rewrite the paper. Revisions and second opportunities to write papers must be completed within the next academic term. If the student passes after revisions are made, doctoral status is restored; if the student fails after revisions, matriculation in the doctoral program is terminated.	
FYC	Take home. Focuses on student's major and research preparation. Adviser develops exam questions and asks	Preliminary written examinations may be taken during fall semester and during spring	Exam should take place over two weeks; only inanimate references may be used. Student submits electronic and	Student receives notification from adviser. One revision is allowed for all or some questions depending on result. All	Student receives notification within 2-3 weeks of submission of the written

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
	committee members to review and critique them prior to giving them to student. No page length is specified. Students are expected to format documents in APA style.	semester until May 1. It is sometimes possible for students to make arrangements with their advisors to take their written examinations during the summer if (a) sufficient time is allowed for the advisor and examining committee members to prepare the examination questions during spring semester and (b) the assessment of the examination is not expected until two to three weeks into fall semester.	print version of the completed work to the adviser. Additional hard copies may be requested by committee members. It is the student's responsibility to ensure delivery of documents to all readers.	members of the committee read and evaluate each exam question and vote on the final result.	responses.
Literacy	Take home. Students will write two papers: one for advisor and the second for a committee member (decided with advisor; in certain cases, a third paper may be	Students should discuss written preliminary exam with advisor as they near completion of their coursework.	Negotiated with faculty. Typically, students will have 4 to 6 weeks to complete each paper.	Each paper is read by the faculty member who is advising the paper, who also communicates the result to the student (and to advisor for paper written for committee	For each paper, approximately three weeks from the date that paper is submitted.

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
	written). Students will consult with their advisor and committee member with regard to paper topics and scope.			member). Grading may result in a Pass, a Deferred Pass (with conditions), or a Fail. If both papers result in a Pass, the student will proceed to the oral preliminary examination stage. If either paper results in a Deferred Pass, the student will be notified of what is required in order to have the conditions removed. If either paper results in a Fail, matriculation is suspended and the student must request permission to rewrite the paper. Revisions and second opportunities to write papers must be completed within the next academic term. If the student passes after revisions are made, doctoral status is restored; if the student fails after	

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
				revisions, matriculation in the doctoral program is terminated.	
LT	Timed, closed book and Take-home	Exams scheduled second week in Fall and Spring terms.	Two 4-hour, closed book exams proctored in a 9-hour session (1 hr. lunch) on campus. It includes 1 LT question and 1 question from student's "outside of major" committee member. A one-week take-home exam, which is written by the adviser in consultation with student (student may or may not see/know exam question prior to beginning). Take home response to be 10-12 pages, not exceeding 15 pages, double spaced, etc. Student may use materials but is not	Exams will be assessed within four weeks and results will be shared with students. The LT exam and take-home exam are graded by all LT faculty. The outside question is graded by your outside committee member.	4 weeks

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
			permitted to interact with anyone about the content of the response.		
Math Ed – (2005 Info)	(Contact adviser) Take home and in house: Take home consists of 3 questions highlighting 3 areas. Students have 1 week to complete responses to these 3 questions. One involves research design (mixed methods). Students may develop a manuscript to be submitted for publication as an alternative to one of the take-home questions. In-house (closed book) exam involves a question related to a topic (from list of possible topics). This	Each fall and spring as needed; dates announced during preceding semester. Reading list and list of possible topics for exam questions is provided to students in advance.		All members of grad faculty in math ed read the exams. A rubric is used for evaluating them (High pass, pass, pass with conditions, no pass). Students receive feedback on exams no later than 2 weeks after completing the in-house exam. Written feedback highlights strengths and weaknesses. In the case of no pass, student needs to retake the entire exam at a later time to remain in program.	Within 2 weeks after submitting papers.

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
	question assesses students' "walking around" knowledge and is embedded in a realistic context. Students have 3-4 hours to complete this exam.				
Science Ed: Purpose The purpose of the exam is to determine the breadth and depth of the student's knowledge of the research literature in science education and the supporting field and their ability to apply that knowledge to research and practice.					
Science Ed	Take home exam. Adviser notifies committee members to ask for questions. Exams related to coursework and a reading list. Two in- area members write two exam questions. Outside member has option of assigning a question or not. Adviser informs student of topics for exam,	Student notifies adviser by end of 2nd week of semester in which s/he wants to take exam. Committee members submit questions to adviser before end of 5th week of semester	10 days to complete exam questions.	All in-area committee members read responses to all questions within two weeks. External members who submitted questions read the responses to their question as do the in-area committee members. Exam readers submit their judgments and comments to adviser within 10 days of receiving the student's responses, with vote of Pass, Fail, or Pass with Reservations. Reservations	Within 10 days after receiving student's response.

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
	but not the questions. Adviser prepares exam; student is allowed 10 days to complete the exam. The response to each question is expected to be approximately 10 pages double spaced.			and stipulate areas of study that must be undertaken before oral if that is necessary. Adviser writes letter to student with assessment of examination performance.	
SLC purpose of prelims: For SLC, the prelim process is forward-oriented that is, we see the prelims as an opportunity for the student to move *forward* towards the dissertation by integrating past work and synthesizing additional work (rather than simply summarizing topics covered in coursework). The purpose of the exam is for the student to demonstrate sufficient knowledge of the scholarly work related to the dissertation topic (as well as broader SLC field), analytical thinking, and academic writing skills, such that completing the dissertation is possible.					
SLC	Take home papers that the student writes independently. The topics and length are negotiated with the committee member for whom the student is writing. Students are responsible for asking faculty members to serve on their	The prelim exams are taken during the regular academic year. The prelim written exam is taken towards the end of coursework, typically in the 3rd year for a full-time student. Students take the required SLC year-long research seminar (CI	The time frame is negotiated with the committee member for whom the student is writing and can vary. The time frame is ideally 4-6 weeks.	Once the student submits the written exam to the committee member who assigned the question, the committee member reads it and informs the student and adviser of the outcome (in writing, usually via email) within 2-3 weeks.	The committee member reads the exam and informs the student and adviser of the outcome within

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
	committee and meeting individually with the adviser and committee members to negotiate each topic. The student typically writes three questions (often with one faculty member opting out of question-writing). One of the questions must focus on research methodology. The student must make sure that all questions are submitted to adviser as they are received in order to guarantee that there is little to no overlap among the questions.	8161 + CI 8162, offered every other year) before taking prelims. If circumstances warrant, it may be possible for a student to take prelims concurrently with the seminar.		If the student fails the exam, the committee member should give general remarks about why the exam failed and offer the option of a second chance to respond. The length of time allowed for the re-write is stipulated by the committee member. If the student fails two or more exams on the second chance, s/he will be counseled out of the program.	2-3 weeks.

Social Studies – Purpose

The purpose of the paper is to provide evidence of the student's ability to investigate and report on a significant issue in social studies education. Students are encouraged to focus on an issue that will serve as background material for the dissertation.

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
Social Studies	Scholarly paper or 30-50 pages, to be of publishable quality; may or may not include data collection. Should be helpful to the student in preparation for the dissertation. The paper should include a critical analysis of prior scholarship on the selected topic and must reflect the student's competence in both social studies education and educational research, in terms of content knowledge, knowledge of research tools, devising research questions, referencing theory, marshalling evidence, and developing an argument. The paper may or may not involve	Typically September 1 – December 15 OR May 1 – August 15	3.5 months	Faculty adviser notifies student of results. Revision allowed, amount of time varies with student.	Students should be notified of the results within 1 month of paper submission.

	TYPE	EXAM TAKEN	EXAM DUE	NOTIFICATION	EVALUATION COMPLETED
	the collection of original field-based data. The paper must, however, highlight the student's ability to make a forceful, coherent, substantive academic argument employing the stylistic conventions of the field, including full references and a bibliography.				

Preliminary Oral Exam

	TIMING	PURPOSE	CONTENT	FUTURE WORK
	Timing How soon should oral exam be scheduled after the student receives notification of having passed written prelims?	**Purpose** Looking more at past to assess knowledge gained? More at future to assess knowledge for dissertation research?	**Content** Covering any course in the student's program or focusing more on the written prelim?	**Future Work** Covering work related to student's dissertation (prospectus, literature review)
Art Ed	Contact adviser.			
CaT		The overall purpose of the exam is to determine the depth and understanding of the candidate's work thus far in the program and their ability to engage in oral discourse with colleagues.	Includes knowledge of their fields of expertiese, primarily topics addressed in the written prelims. Students are asked to share their written prelim papers with all members of their committee prior to the exam so that members will be familiar with the student's work prior to the oral prelim exam.	
FYC	In consultation with the student's advisor, oral preliminary examinations may occur during fall or	Objectives of the oral preliminary examination in the FYC track: • To demonstrate the ability to engage	Primarily, the content of the oral exam reflects that of the written exam.	Because the content of the written and oral exam reflect student specific

	spring semester or with special arrangement, summer, depending on when the written exam was taken. No set time is required for the oral exam date but it is highly desireable for the oral exam to be scheduled soon after passing of the written portion (e.g., two weeks after learning of the result).	in oral discourse on topics related to one's major/specialization and research preparation. • To demonstrate familiarity with an area of literature related to one's major/specialization. • To demonstrate ability to use higher order cognitive skills such as analysis, critique, and synthesis. • To demonstrate ability to apply understanding of research methodology and methods to a researchable question in one's area of professional practice. • To demonstrate ability to develop a coherent, comprehensive, and feasible research study. • To demonstrate the ability to take alternate stances on professional issues and identify one's own stance on those issues. • To demonstrate the ability to listen carefully to others' questions and	The oral exam provides the in depth opportunity for committee members and the student to delve into specific content and competencies in the student's program. Towards the end of the two-hour examination, the student will be excused from the examination room, and the examining committee members will follow the procedures outlined by the Graduate School for determining and recording the committee's assessment of the student's performance on the examination.	interests, it is possible that a whole question or elements of a question may be a foundation for the students' dissertation. However this is not an expectation, and is dependent on the student's individual situation.

		comments.		
Literacy	Flexible; however, student should begin process of scheduling oral exam within two or three weeks of passing written exams.	Both; dependent on focus of written exam.	Potentially both, but tends to focus more on topics and questions raised by written exams.	Includes discussion of dissertation to the extent that this was treated in written exams.
LT	Upon satisfactory completion of written exam, the student should schedule an oral exam with her/his committee.	To provide an opportunity for students to demonstrate their understanding of major concepts in the field and to develop solutions to germane topics.	exam questions asked typically relate to the student's degree plan (courses taken etc.) and her/his proposed area of research	
Math Ed	Contact Adviser.			
Science Ed	The oral exam should be scheduled during the same semester as the written exams are completed. Students should contact their committee for scheduling immediately once they are informed of their written exam results.	During the prelim exams committee members will have an opportunity to ask further questions related to concerns or questions generated from the written exams. Unless there are significant concerns about a students' past performance in coursework or written exams the second portion of the exam will be forward looking and explore possible research topics and designs for future studies.	The first portion of the exam will focus on topics related to the written exam responses although students are expected to be able to relate any of their course content to questions during the prelim exam.	Students will be expected to inform their committee of current thoughts on their dissertation topic at the end of the prelim exam. Students are not expected to have definite research questions but should be prepared to discuss a topic of interest.

SLC	Once the student has passed all of the written exams, the student should schedule a two-hour meeting for the oral exam by contacting all committee members and arranging for a room (through Graduate Studies). We encourage the student to schedule the orals as soon as possible after all written exams have been passed.	Assessing knowledge of the field and the preparation/readiness needed for successful completion of dissertation.	Technically the preliminary oral exam can include questions about the written exams and past coursework, but typically the focus is on assessing knowledge for the dissertation (using the written exams as the springboard for the discussion).	If the oral exam progresses well, the last 30 minutes or so typically focus on specific plans for the dissertation.
Social Studies	Can be scheduled within 2 weeks of passing written exam.	Focus is generally on the written exam, but students may be asked about any area about which we feel they should have expertise. Typical questions include: How would you describe the status of social studies research? What would you say are the strengths and weaknesses of the existing research? Whose scholarly work do you consider exemplary? Why?	Focusing more on the written prelim, but see above.	Because the paper should be related to the dissertation topic, we typically ask questions about how the student is conceptualizing her/his dissertation study.